

STUDENT GUIDE & CLINICAL EXTERNSHIP HANDBOOK

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QUALIFICATIONS

Students must meet all attendance, academic, scanning proficiency, financial aid, student accounts and physical requirements prior to being cleared for externship. Students that have failed a class(es) must repeat and pass the class in order to be assigned to externship. Students that do not meet the minimum hours required, must make up those hours prior to being cleared for externship. In the event a student is not proficient in scanning, that student must meet with the Program Director to determine a plan to qualify for externship.

CLINICAL CLEARANCE

All students must obtain clearance from each department in order to be approved to go on externship. This includes verification of all required hours being fulfilled, all classes have been passed with satisfactory grades and proficiency, all Financial Aid obligations are met, all tuition obligations have been met and student account is current. The registrar will confirm the student clearance and communicate with the Clinical Coordinator when each student is eligible to begin their Clinical Rotation.

CLINICAL SITE ASSIGNMENT

All CURE externship sites are within a 60 mile radius of The Campus.

All students will be in communication with the Clinical Team to identify their career goals throughout the program. Prior to the end of the last quarter of didactic each student will meet individually with the Director of Student Services and the Clinical Coordinator to discuss their goals and pathway. The Director of Student Services then works with the Program Director, Clinical Coordinator and Registrar to communicate the goals of each student and decide, as a team, the best externship placement for each student.

Students entering the externship portion of the program will be assigned to a site based on their pathway to the registry which is dictated by their highest level of completed education.

- **PATHWAY #1 – HIGH SCHOOL DIPLOMA/GED**
  CCI – Clinical Hours will be completed in Vascular or Cardiac* The entirety of the clinical rotation will be in one of the specialties listed above

- **PATHWAY #2 – ASSOCIATE DEGREE**
  ARRT – Clinical hours will be completed in General Ultrasound including – abdomen, OBGYN and small parts

- **PATHWAY #3 – BACHELOR DEGREE**
  ARDMS – Students will communicate with the Clinical Coordinator, Program Director and/or Director of Student Services to identify their chosen specialty of focus for their clinical rotation. These students by default complete their clinical hours in general ultrasound. Exceptions can be made upon review of attendance, grades throughout the program and class rank in the specialty of choice and student conduct.

CURE is responsible for assigning students to an externship site based on their pathway**. CURE does not guarantee placement in any specific specialty or site due to student preference**.

CURE supports the goals and aspirations of our students and will work with each individual to place them in a specialty of their preference, however many factors are taken into consideration when placing students in a specific specialty or location. This includes, grades throughout the program, grades and class rank in the specialty of choice, attendance and student conduct throughout the course of the program. In the event a student is not placed in the first specialty of their choice the Director of Student Services will work with each individual on a plan to be able to reach those goals in their career. There are many opportunities to cross

train in additional specialties upon graduation, once registered and the Director of Student Services can help to guide the graduate in that respect.

Any student wishing to be placed in a specialty inconsistent with their pathway will be evaluated on a case by case basis by the Administration and Academic Team. This is not guaranteed, and it should not be assumed that because a request was made that it will be granted. These students must be ranked in the top 3 students in the class of the specialty they wish to pursue in order to be considered.

Students do not have the ability to change externship sites or specialties once assigned to a site.

Students currently working in the medical field that have a site that has agreed to allow them to complete their clinical rotation at their place of employment must communicate with the Clinical Coordinator and Director of Student Services as soon as possible so CURE can begin the affiliation process with that facility. The information needed is Facility name, address, supervisor name, email, phone number. Depending on the facility, this process can be lengthy and it cannot delay the start of a clinical rotation once didactic has been completed. Therefore, even if a site is identified by the student, it is not guaranteed that affiliation will be granted.

REFUSAL OF A CLINICAL SITE

CURE is obligated to offer students one (1) clinical externship site. While the Clinical Department does their best to take into consideration the student's specialty preference, geographic location, work schedule, transportation, or any other restrictions etc. it is not guaranteed that any requests can be accommodated. If a site is refused, the student may be responsible for finding their own clinical site that CURE is not currently affiliated with.

CLINICAL ON BOARDING REQUIREMENTS

All students must provide, to the campus an up to date PPD or Quantiferon blood test (TB Test), Flu shot (seasonal), negative drug test and proof of COVID vaccine no more than 30 days prior to beginning clinical rotation, as well as up to date immunization titers and physical. Every Clinical Site has their own requirements related to onboarding. Some sites require a background check (cost incurred by student), additional applications, resume. It is the responsibility of the student to comply with and submit all required onboarding documentation to the Clinical Team as soon as possible to prevent delay in starting the Clinical Rotation.

Some clinical sites require an interview prior to accepting a student for a rotation. Interviews require an updated resume which can be sent to the Director of Student Services for review prior to the interview. Students scheduled for an interview are not guaranteed a clinical rotation at that site. Placement following an interview is ultimately the decision of the Clinical Site Supervisor.

SCHEDULE

Externship students MUST complete a minimum of 24 hours per week. If the facility has the capacity, students can complete up to but not exceeding 30 hours per week. Schedules of externships are based on the schedule of the facility assigned to and can be any combination of days and times Monday – Sunday.

Clinical externship schedules are determined by the Externship Clinical Site Supervisor and the Student. The schedule MUST be communicated with the Clinical Team prior to beginning a rotation.

The schedule identified at the beginning of the rotation must be adhered to. It is not permitted for a student to attend clinicals outside of the documented schedule.

If the schedule changes weekly (due to patient volume, scheduling etc.), the student must communicate the schedule for the following week with the Clinical Coordinator, via email no later than the Friday of the prior week.

If the schedule changes due to the Site schedule, patient scheduling, Site closures for holidays etc. this MUST be communicated with the Clinical Coordinator immediately so they can verify that information with the Site.

If a student needs to change their schedule, they must state, in writing the reason for the schedule change to the Clinical Team. The Clinical Team will then discuss the change with the Clinical Site and determine if the change is appropriate and can be approved. Students must get approval from the Clinical Team prior to attending at any other times than the agreed upon schedule at the commencement of their Clinical Rotation.

Changing a schedule or non-attendance because of work is not acceptable and will not be permitted.

ATTENDANCE

Attendance for all students shall be documented in their clinical log a daily basis indicating time in, time out for lunch, time returning from lunch and time out for the day. All clinical logs must be signed by the Externship Clinical Site Supervisor no later than the Friday of that week. If all required information is not filled out on the clinical log, it will be rejected by the campus and the student will have 1 business day to return the clinical log with all of the required information verified by their Externship Clinical Site Supervisor.

Any break weeks, days off, closures or holidays the school observes do not apply to externship students. Clinical students are expected to fulfill their required weekly hours at their site, at all times unless the site is closed on a specific day. In the event the facility is closed, it is the student's responsibility to communicate that with the Clinical Team immediately (prior to the closure). All attempts should be made to make up those hours on an alternate day that week as long as they do not exceed 30 hours. If it is not possible to make up those hours in the same week, the hours will be tacked on to the end of your clinical rotation.

It is up to the Registrar, Program Director and/or President to determine whether there are disciplinary actions required if attendance requirements are not met.

CURE Clinical Team and Registrar will monitor all clinical hours and cases on a weekly basis based on the clinical logs submitted no later than the Monday of the following week. It is highly suggested to send the clinical logs on the last day of externship for that week to avoid lateness.

Students who miss more than three days/quarter, will be given an ATTENDANCE WARNING and it may affect student Financial Aid eligibility.

If a student does not attend externship for 14 consecutive days, they will be dismissed from the CURE program.

Time off for any reason other than a medical reason is not permitted or tolerated at any time during a clinical rotation. Should a medical problem arise, it is the student's responsibility to communicate that with the Clinical Coordinator and Registrar immediately.

Vacations are not permitted at any point during externship.

LATENESS

Lateness is not tolerated during clinical rotations. Clinical externships should be approached by the student as if it is their job. The Clinical Team frequently communicates with sites and if CURE is notified of ongoing lateness, the student will be scheduled for an on-campus meeting with the Clinical Team and Program Director. If a student is late, they must accurately account for their tardiness on their clinical log. Students do not get credit for any time missed. If the lateness continues, the student can be dismissed from their clinical rotation at that site and will have to withdraw from the program until another site is identified. Hours completed practicing at CURE due to dismissal from a Site do not count toward externship hours.

LEAVING EARLY

If a student needs to leave early for a planned reason (doctor's appointment etc.) the Clinical Team must be notified ahead of time not after the fact.

If an emergent situation arises while at the site, please contact the CURE Clinical Team immediately to notify them of your situation.

ILLNESS/EMERGENCY

In the event that you are sick, or an emergent situation arises and you are going to miss ANY time from externship, the Externship Clinical Supervisor, Clinical Coordinator and Registrar MUST all be notified in writing, immediately. It is unacceptable to only communicate with the Externship Site Supervisor. If the campus is not notified of an absence or time missed, disciplinary action will be taken. All medical absences require official documentation, on letterhead signed by a medical professional and must be submitted to the campus as soon as possible. In some cases, medical clearance to return to externship may be required to resume the clinical rotation. This documentation must be provided.

CLINICAL PROFICIENCIES

Externship students are expected to progress through their externship constantly improving their skills related to scanning proficiency, identification of pathologies, and scan times. Each site is provided with a Clinical Assessment survey quarterly to ensure each student is progressing through their rotation adequately. In the event a student is not adequately progressing, action may be taken by the Clinical Team and Program Director to determine the best way to support that student to help bring them to proper proficiency standards. If a student is dismissed from their site due to lack of proficiency, that student will be redirected back to the campus until proper proficiency is met. Hours completed on Campus due to dismissal from a site do not count toward externship hours.

CLINICAL LOG REQUIREMENTS

Students involved in clinical externships are required to document ALL clinical hours and scans via the provided Clinical Log. Only the abbreviations on the clinical log for each exam are to be used. Each log is to be filled out neatly and clearly, in its entirety in order for it to be accepted by the campus. Any information crossed out or changed must be initialed by the Supervising Tech in order for it to be accepted. It is encouraged to rewrite the entire log and have it signed to prevent suspicion of forgery. Under no circumstances should any clinical log be missing any information. This includes time in and out including breaks, supervisor contact information, dates, exams, findings, outcomes, signatures etc. Under no circumstances should any information be pre-filled in, no one other than the student should be

writing on the clinical log except for where the Supervising Tech is signing or initialing. Do not initial, sign or date for the Supervising Technologist.

Only blue or black ink is permitted. No pencil, white out, erasable pen or colored ink will be accepted.

Should you need to use more than one page, it must clearly state on each page – page 1 of 2, page 2 of 2 etc. If you need more than 2 pages, please use additional "page 2".

Each day the Supervising Tech must initial next to the time card verifying hours of attendance for that day. Each week the clinical log must be signed by the student's direct Externship Clinical Site Supervisor no later than the last day of attendance that week. It is unacceptable for the Supervisor to sign a log for weeks prior to the dates on the log.

All logs must be scanned to a PDF file and submitted to the Clinical Coordinator NO LATER than 9:00am the Monday following the prior week of externship. Scan apps can be downloaded on to your phone or a scanner may be used to scan the log into a PDF. The entire page must be readable, or the log will be rejected by the campus. Clinical Logs with multiple pages should be scanned as one PDF document. PICTURES (jpegs) WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED.

It is the responsibility of the student to maintain all original, signed clinical logs for the entirety of their externship. Every 4-6 weeks the student is to drop off their original clinical logs to the Registrar. If that is not possible, the student must notify the Clinical Team immediately to have other arrangements made ahead of time. Upon completion of the clinical rotation, any remaining original logs must be submitted to the Registrar for a final audit of the student file to qualify for graduation of the Program. Missing logs will have to be re-written, signed by their Clinical Site Supervisor and submitted to the Registrar in order to qualify for graduation from the program.

Forgery of any information on a clinical log will result in immediate dismissal from the Program.

CLINICAL RESPONSIBILITIES

Each clinical site expects students to engage in various activities outside of scanning to help support the Imaging Staff. The student is expected to fulfill all requests made by Staff. If a student feels they are engaging in activities that are inconsistent with their role, they must notify the campus immediately so the concerns can be addressed by the Campus and Clinical Supervisor. Do not directly confront any Supervisor about these tasks. The Campus will determine if the activities requested are outside of the scope of duties for a student. These additional responsibilities typically include but are not limited to:

- Responsible for ensuring gloves, gel, towels, sanitizing-spray, paper rolls and other scanning supplies are available and in stock upon arrival and before they leave for the day. If supplies are not available, notify the person in charge so they direct you to the supplies to re- stock the scan rooms.
- Responsible to ensure that there is clean paper on the scan bed between patients.
- Responsible to ensure that probes are cleaned with appropriate sanitizing techniques before and in between patients.
- Responsible to ensure that probe cords are not tangled in any way and are not touching the floor.
- Responsible to ensure that the scanning room is clean and in order at all times.
- Answering phones only if directed to do so
- Greeting patients and bringing them to the exam room

FINANCIAL AID/ TUITION PAYMENTS DURING EXTERNSHIP

All students must complete the most current FAFSA for the academic year whether on campus or attending externships. The most current FAFSA is available each year in October. Failure to complete the FAFSA can result in loss of Financial Aid.

All tuition payments must continue to be paid on the same schedule as agreed upon at the beginning of the program. Failure to make payments or payment defaults may result in suspension or dismissal from an externship site.

No student will be permitted to begin an externship clinical rotation with an overdue/outstanding tuition balance. All payments must be current at the point of beginning the clinical rotation and continue a current status throughout the duration of the externship. If a student defaults on tuition payments prior to their externship, their start date will be delayed. If a student defaults on tuition payments during externship they face suspension from the clinical site and potential permanent removal.

Upon completion of didactic, students will have 10 days to become current with their tuition, make a payment arrangement or face dismissal from the program.

If you are experiencing financial hardship, it is imperative that you bring it to the attention of the Student Accounts representative immediately. Refusal to communicate with Student Accounts may lead to dismissal from the program.

PROHIBITED CLINICAL BEHAVIORS

VISUAL CELL PHONES

Each student is responsible to ensure that no cell phones are visible to any staff, student or patient within the clinic at any times. Visible cell phones in an exam room can result in immediate dismissal from the Clinical Site as that is a violation of HIPPA. If it is an emergency, wait until the exam is complete, go into the hallway or other private area away from the sight of patients and staff. Never at any point should pictures be taken in or around the facility. Facetime calls are strictly forbidden and will result in dismissal from the site.

SLEEPING

Any student found sleeping at any time throughout a clinical day WILL be sent home and will lose all hours for that day. Dismissal from the Clinical Site may be considered.

BEHAVIOR DURING AN EXAM WITH PATIENT

Please refrain from asking any questions or making any comments during the exam and only speak when you are spoken to, as to not interrupt the exam or raise patient concerns. Please save questions until the patient has left the room. Do not question authority in front of the patient. A notebook can be used to take notes on any questions that may arise.

INTERRUPTING EXAMS

Please do not enter or leave the scan room once the exam has begun. You should remain in the exam room for the entirety of the examination whether you are scanning or observing. Students who must leave the exam room for any reason cannot return into the exam room once an exam has started.

PATIENT PRIVACY

If the patient needs time to change, before or after the examination, please ensure to leave the room and give adequate time before knocking and re-entering the scan room.

UNIFORM

You are required to be in full uniform at all times. The required uniform is CURE black scrubs and optional CURE lab coat (if permitted). If the student is cold they can wear a solid long sleeve shirt, cardigan or well fitted zip down sweatshirt. At no time are pull over hoodies or outerwear that is baggy or inconsistent with the color of the scrubs. No “jogger” style scrub pants are permitted. If a site requests a specific color of scrubs the student is responsible to comply with that request. Solid colored black or white sneakers or any type of medical shoes must be worn. There are to be no open toe shoes, crocs, Uggs etc. worn at any time at clinical sites. You are not permitted to wear any hats/headpieces, unless it is for religious purposes. Long hair must be clean and pulled back. Nails should be kept short and neat. Long acrylic nails are not permitted as they interfere with the ability to scan. No tattoos/piercings should be visible at any time. Failure to comply with dress code will result in being sent to a store to comply with the dress code or sent home for the day. Repeated violations of dress code policy may lead to dismissal from the site.

PPE

You must comply with the PPE requirements of your clinical site. If we are notified that proper PPE compliance is not being met, you will be dismissed from the Clinical Site. PPE is for the safety of the patient, staff and student.

LANGUAGE

There is to be no use of foul or unacceptable language (slang) of any kind while you are in your clinical

externship. You are required to always maintain a professional demeanor. Proper medical terminology must be used at all times.

DISMISSAL

In the event that an extern violates the terms of the externship agreement the student will be dismissed from their externship site. If a student violates the CURE code of conduct or Externship Site policies, the student will be dismissed from their externship site and possibly The Program.

Each Externship Clinical Supervisor has the right to terminate a student from their clinical rotation if the students violate any of the policies at that facility. CURE frequently communicates with Externship Sites to ensure any issues that arise are addressed immediately. However, if the student continues to violate CURE or Site policies they will be terminated from that site and will be redirected back to the Campus until another Clinical Site is assigned. Hours completed at CURE due to dismissal from a site DO NOT count toward externship hours. Should a student be dismissed from their site, they will have 14 days to identify an alternative site. If a student is terminated by more than one Externship Site, they will be dismissed from The Program.

CLINICAL SITE DISMISSAL

Students may be dismissed from clinical externship for the following reasons, including but not limited to:

- Failure to comply with HIPPA, patient or student volunteer confidentiality &/or privileged information concerning patient data, records, & conditions. This includes any phone use including taking pictures anywhere at the clinical facility
- Posting pictures or videos on social media anywhere at the clinical site or with facility staff
- Posting inappropriate pictures or videos of any type on social media – if you wouldn't want your employer to see it, don't post it!
- Failure to adhere to the CURE Code of Ethics and Code of Conduct.
- Willful destruction of clinical site property
- Intoxication or bringing intoxicants onto the premises or clinical facility premises.
- Attending a clinical rotation knowingly having a communicable illness that could potentially endanger students, patients, or staff.
- Use of non-prescribed controlled substances/inappropriate use of prescribed substances.
- Falsification or misinterpretation of any school or clinical site record, transcript, report, or clinical logs.
- Cheating on an academic examination or any other form of academic dishonesty, i.e. plagiarism.

- Unreasonable absences or tardiness and similar instances are cause for dismissal after warning or probation has been issued.
- Refusal to participate in ultrasound exams
- Offering, soliciting, or attempting to solicit, drugs.
- Committing or threatening violence.
- Charged with, or convicted of, a crime while enrolled at CURE.
- Failure to respect CURE students and staff privacy, i.e. gossiping, and matters relating to personal relationships.
- Unwelcomed &/or inappropriate behavior towards patients, students, instructors &/or clinical staff. That includes fraternizing of any kind with clinical site/school staff and patients.
- Illegal activity of any kind.
- Failure to comply with dress code policy

COMPLETION OF CLINICAL ROTATION

Upon completion of the Clinical Rotation the Clinical Team will verify with the Site that all hours have been sufficiently completed. A final Externship Assessment will be sent to the Clinical Supervisor which determines your final grade for externship. The Clinical Team will then communicate with the Registrar, Financial Aid, Student Accounts and the Program Director that the student has met the hours requirement to complete externship.

Upon confirmation of completion of externship hours, the student must immediately contact the Director of Student Services to begin the Exit Process. The Exit Process is a multi-step process required in order to successfully complete the program and graduate.

EXIT PROCESS

The Exit Process consists of several steps that must be completed in order to graduate from the program.

1. Meeting with the Registrar to hand in remaining original clinical logs:
    - The Registrar then completes a full audit of grades, attendance, clinical logs, externship assessment etc. to confirm qualification for graduation. A follow up appointment is required to obtain graduation documentation including, transcripts, clinical letters, certificate and program completion letters (if tuition is paid in full).
2. Meeting with Student Accounts to ensure all payments are up to date and/or paid in full. * Students do not receive a Certificate of Completion until all tuition obligations are met
3. Meeting with Financial Aid to complete Exit Counseling
4. Meeting with Student Services to complete Exit Interview and discuss registry and career options
5. Follow up meeting with the Registrar, to obtain graduation documentation following full audit of student file. This process takes 2-4 weeks from the first visit. Each pathway requires different documentation and the time frame in which we receive certain documentation may vary depending on the Clinical Site Supervisor sending this documentation to the Campus. We will only release all

of the graduation documentation, at once, to the graduate directly. We do not send graduation documentation in the mail.

It is the responsibility of the student to return to campus to pick up their graduation documentation.

Failure to complete the exit process may result in dismissal of the program. Be sure to answer all phone calls, emails and texts from CURE staff immediately to ensure you complete this process and successfully graduate. If you change your contact information at any point during the program it is essential that you communicate this with CURE staff so we can update our records. If you are unreachable and/or refuse to answer communications from the staff, you may be dropped from the program or miss out on available job opportunities.

IMPORTANT CONTACT INFORMATION

Program Director: Siham Wadiri MHA, RDMS, RVT
Email: siham@cure.edu
Phone Number: 914-448-2873 Ext. 104

Externship Support Administraor: Leigh DeWitt, RCS
Email: leigh@cure.edu
Phone Number: 845-467-7217

Director of Student & Career Services/ Clinical Department: Amanda Murasso
Email: amanda@cure.edu
Phone Number: 917-436-2939

Registrar: Sajid Chaudhry
Email: sajid@cure.edu
Phone Number: 914-448-2873 Ext. 112

Financial Aid: Garrett Ramos
Email: garrett@cure.edu
Phone Number: 914-448-2873 Ext. 107

Student Accounts & Business Office Manager: Karen Hendricks
Email: karen.hendricks@cure.edu
Phone Number: 914-448-2873 Ext. 111

Clinical Handbook Review:

1. CURE Clinical Sites are within a_____mile radius of the campus
2. Absences exceeding_____in one quarter result in an attendance warning
3. Cell phones can be used to take pictures in exam rooms if the patient has a rare pathology: (T) (F)
4. CURE externship students are not expected to engage in any activities other than scanning (T) (F)
5. Who needs to be notified in the event of an absence/schedule change from externship?
    1. Clinical Site Supervisor
    2. Clinical Coordinator
    3. Program Director
    4. Clinical Site Supervisor, Clinical Coordinator and Registrar
6. Medical documentation must be submitted to the Registrar to excuse absence due to illness (T) (F)
7. I don't have to use medical terminology if I do not know the proper term (T) (F)
8. I can change my externship site or specialty if I do not like it (T) (F)
9. I can go on vacation as long as it doesn't exceed 7 consecutive days (T) (F)
10. In order to graduate from the Program, I need to:
    1. Finish 900 clinical hours
    2. Complete the exit process with all required departments
    3. Hand in original clinical logs
    4. Meet with Student Services
    5. Pass didactic and externship
    6. All of the above
11. Clinical logs must be submitted by_____of the following week
12. I do not need to keep my original clinical logs (T) (F)
13. I need to complete a FAFSA every year even if I'm out on externship (T) (F)
14. I can change my clinical schedule if it is interfering with my work schedule (T) (F)
15. If a clinical site requests a background check who's responsibility is it to pay for it?
    1. The Clinical Site
    2. CURE
    3. The Student

CURE STUDENT GUIDE &
CLINICAL EXTERNSHIP MANUAL ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Student Name: _____

Cohort: _____

Email Address: _____

Phone Number: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____